Japanese Language Society



Third Meeting | 3回目の対面

Agenda

- Important Particles and Conjunctions
  - から (kara)
  - に・へ (ni / he)
  - だけ (dake)
  - けど (kedo)
  - の (no)



PART I: Particles and Postpositions

助詞と後置詞

Particles and Postpositions

- What we know as prepositions in English (for, in, at, from, etc.) are **postpositions** in Japanese.
- Words like “from” come after the word they modify, which can be confusing.
  - English: from America
  - Japanese: アメリカから – America from
- The same applies for particles, they always follow the word they’re modifying.
  - Ex: は, the topic marker
  - 私は

PART II: Kara

から

Kara / から

- Kara has 2 meanings, from and because.
  - From:
    - 東京から, from Tokyo
    - It can also mean since
    - 昨日から雨が降っています。
  - Because:
    - A bit more complicated
    - The cause comes before the effect in Japanese.
    - 東京は美しいから、そこへ行きます。

PART III: Ni and He

に・へ

に・へ / Ni and He

- に and へ are two particles that concern destination and heading.
  - に
    - Indicates the target or destination of a verb
    - 学校に行きます。
    - “I go to school.”
    - Can be more abstract with its “destinations”.
  - へ
    - Pronounced e, not he
    - Ni emphasizes the destination, he shows the direction.
    - Adds direction to verbs that don’t indicate it
    - コンビニへ歩いた



PART IV: Dake

だけ

Dake / だけ

- だけ means "only" and can be used for nouns, adjectives, and verbs.
  - With nouns:
    - 水だけを飲みます
    - "[I] only drink water."
  - With adjectives:
    - 有名なだけでしょ？
    - [They're] just famous, right?
  - With verbs:
    - 見ただけだ
    - "[I] only saw [him]."

PART V: Kedo

けど

Kedo / けど

- けど means "but". It is a conjunctive particle, connecting related sentences together.
  - Example:
  - 金はないけど夢はある。
  - [I] don't have money, but [I] have dreams.
- The full word is actually けれども, but it's only used in very formal speech (There's also けれど, but same thing: it's only used in formal speech).

PART VI: No

の

No / の

- の is a versatile particle in Japanese. It is used primarily to indicate ownership, but it has many other uses beyond that.
  - Example:
    - 私のピザ。
    - "My pizza."

    - 誰の？彼の!
    - “Who’s?” “His!”

Thank you!

ありがとうございます